VIT Carpool — UI/UX Redesign Blueprint

Prepared 29 October 2026 · Based on 13 screenshots of the local build (localhost:5173) · No repository access · Design planning only; nothing here has been implemented or tested

1. Executive summary

VIT Carpool already does a lot: discovery, booking with driver approval, recurring commutes, ride alerts, vehicles, messaging, notifications, ratings, and strict student/faculty separation. The problem is not missing features. The product does not yet present them as one coherent system.

Three structural causes (all P0):

1. **Navigation exposes every feature at the top level.** Ten text links, two icon buttons, a name chip and Sign Out compete for a header about 1,190 px wide. “Find Rides”, “Offer a Ride”, “My Rides” and “Ride Alerts” wrap onto two lines, the brand tagline wraps onto three, and “Vehicles” touches the chat icon.
2. **There is no layout system.** Estimated from the screenshots, pages use at least ten different content widths, from about 390 px (sign-in) to about 945 px (dashboard and discovery). Card, tab, header and button styles change from page to page.
3. **The build process leaks into the product.** Examples: “PLATFORM PREVIEW”, “(Planned)”, “(Design Requirement)”, “ARCHITECTURAL REQUIREMENT & SECURITY DESIGN”, “Local Dev Fast-Fill (Test Accounts)”, a raw enum (MANUAL_ID_REVIEW), and repeated seed-like records.

Most important caution. Several things that look like visual problems may be data or state defects: 14 identical-looking conversations, booking-request notifications minutes apart, repeated identical ride alerts, bookings still “Pending” or “Confirmed” for a departure two days in the past, and counts that don’t reconcile (33 published rides vs 29 upcoming). A redesign must not hide these with styling. Section 13 lists how to verify each one.

Recommendation. Adopt **“Quiet Utility”**: a restrained, light, typographic interface (flat surfaces, hairline borders, one deep-blue accent) with a distinctive **route spine** element used everywhere a trip appears. Reduce navigation to five destinations (bottom bar on phones), define three content widths, introduce one small token set and about 25 shared components, and roll out in six phases with visual-regression checks. No backend capability is required except where a change is explicitly marked optional.

Top P0 changes

- Five-destination navigation with a bottom bar on mobile (Section 7).
- Three layout widths and one page shell (Section 6).
- Remove internal and development wording; make sure the dev fast-fill cannot ship to production.
- Role-aware dashboard that leads with the next trip and requests needing action.
- Driver requests actionable in place (Accept / Decline), not behind a banner link.
- One status badge with a stated next action, used for bookings, rides, schedules, vehicles.
- Form validation that doesn't show errors before interaction.
- Investigate duplicates and stale data before polishing those screens.

2. Assessment of the current screenshots

Method. All 13 screens were studied: Home, Dashboard, Find rides, Offer a ride, My rides, Bookings, Recurring, Ride alerts, Vehicles, Messages, Notifications, Profile, Sign-in. The screenshots show one developer account (Arjun Verma) with seeded data, so some content problems are data problems. Widths are estimates from the images; confirm in DevTools. Tags: **[V]** = visual/layout problem observable in the screenshot; **[D]** = possible functional or data issue (a hypothesis to verify, not a confirmed defect).

Screen	What works	Problems
Home	A search-first hero with four fields is the right idea; swap origin/destination; trust chips are the right idea	[V] Badge says "PLATFORM PREVIEW"; copy says "Planned for…"; chips say "(Design Requirement)" and "(Planned)"; link says "Preview driver publishing →"; section label reads "ARCHITECTURAL REQUIREMENT & SECURITY DESIGN". [V] Headline is generic. [V] Fields are double-bordered (input inside a bordered box) and date/seat boxes sit at a different height than the location boxes. [V] Uppercase micro-labels. A signed-in user still lands on a marketing page

Screen	What works	Problems
Dashboard	Pending/confirmed and driving lists exist; clear primary actions	[V] Six equal metric cards with numbers in three colours that carry no meaning. “Campus Audience: STUDENT” is not a metric. Greeting repeats role, email and “Strict STUDENT cohort isolation active”. [D] Display name contains a role label “(Student Driver)”. [D] Counts: 33 published rides, 14 saved alerts, 2 active bookings vs 4 pending requests elsewhere. [D] A pending booking for 27 Oct 4:01 pm still shows on 29 Oct. No “next trip” emphasis
Find rides	Search, More Filters and Reset; price and seats left visible; scope line is useful	[V] Three-column grid of tall cards makes vertical comparison hard. Driver name wraps and rating, “You” and seats chips crowd one row. “Isolated STUDENT Network” is internal wording. No arrival time or pickup detail. [D] Every visible result is the signed-in user’s own ride (“You”, “View Your Published Ride”): own rides in passenger search. [D] “Showing 8 of 29” with no pagination visible
Offer a ride	“Repeat last ride”, saved routes and quick time chips save real effort	[V] Narrow column differs from other pages. “Quick Ride / Custom Ride” tabs add a decision before the form. “Required for new ride” is red before any interaction. Date-time prefilled with the current time (01:18 AM). [D] “Saved Commute Routes (8)” shows two pills. “Load Last Ride” and the first saved route both look selected

Screen	What works	Problems
My rides	Pending-requests banner; tabs with counts	[V] The banner sends drivers to another page to act. 29 near-identical cards in a flat grid with no grouping. The driver's own rating appears on their own rides. Border + grey inner box + chip stack is heavy
Bookings	Status badges, helper line, Chat and Cancel actions	[V] Tab label "My Bookings (Passenger)" wraps. "Confirmed Driver Contact: Kavya Student Rider" reads like a label bug. [D] Departures on 27 Oct still Pending/Confirmed
Recurring	Weekday chips, "10 rides generated", Resume/Edit/Cancel	[V] One card fills a third of the width and leaves the page mostly empty. Route text wraps onto three lines. Dates in ISO format (2026-10-28) unlike the rest of the app. "My Schedules (1)" is styled as a primary button but behaves like a tab. [D] A paused schedule with rides still published: confirm intent and explain it
Ride alerts	Pause, Edit and Delete are clear	[V] Every row identical. "Directional matching enforced" is implementation language. [D] Repeated identical alerts (dashboard says 14). [D] ±5 km radius: confirm this is intended
Vehicles	Cars-only policy is clear	[V] No verification state even though copy says only verified cars are eligible. Edit and Delete carry equal weight. [D] Plate "INVALID123" displayed. [D] Capacity is inconsistent (4 seats for Swift and Fortuner, 5 for i20): total or passenger seats?
Messages	Ride-specific framing is right	[V] Rows lack time, unread state, ride date and avatars; list and thread are not side by side. [D] 14 rows with the same sender, route and message

Screen	What works	Problems
Notifications	Type label, link, Mark Read, delete	[V] Emoji in titles; two generic links per item; blue border on every card. [D] “Unread (0)” while each card shows an unread dot and “Mark Read”. [D] Bell has no badge while chat shows 4. [D] Booking-request notifications at 11:23, 11:25 and 11:26 pm
Profile	Clear verification card; reputation section	[V] Raw “MANUAL_ID_REVIEW”. [D] 12 reviews that appear to be from one reviewer with identical text
Sign-in	Clean card; email-code approach	[V] Duplicate “Sign In / Sign Up” labels (button and tabs); “Offer a Ride” is plain text beside a primary button. Placeholder “your.email@vitstudent.ac.in” presumes a student domain that hasn’t been confirmed with VIT. [D/security] “Local Dev Fast-Fill (Test Accounts)” must never reach production. Dark footer on some pages only

Cross-cutting findings

1. **Hierarchy:** nearly everything is bold or large, and chips, icons, borders and uppercase labels all compete.
2. **Surfaces:** rounded cards of about 20 px radius with border, shadow and nested inner panels.
3. **Colour:** royal blue plus green, amber, purple and yellow chips without a rule for when each is allowed.
4. **Copy:** internal words (cohort, audience isolation, corridor, published, directional matching) appear in user-facing text.
5. **Mobile:** not shown, but the header already fails at about 1,190 px, so phone layouts need to be designed rather than inherited.

3. Research findings

Scope and limits. I reviewed W3C WCAG 2.2, the GOV.UK Design System, Material 3 navigation guidance (via SAP Fiori's documentation of it), Linear's design posts, Stripe's colour-system article, Vercel's Geist documentation, IBM Carbon's loading pattern, Nielsen Norman Group findings as summarized by secondary sources, BlaBlaCar's trust design as described by business and press sources, and Apple HIG values as summarized by third parties. **I did not retrieve primary material on Airbnb or Uber in this pass**, so I make no claims about their specific interfaces. Where a pattern is "common in marketplaces" it is my own recommendation. Re-verify Apple numbers at developer.apple.com before they go into a spec. No statistics below are claimed to apply to VIT Carpool.

#	Source	Finding (paraphrased)	Implication for VIT Carpool (my recommendation)
1	W3C, "What's New in WCAG 2.2" (w3.org/WAI/standards-guidelines/wcag/new-in-22)	Level AA Target Size (Minimum): pointer targets at least 24×24 CSS px unless spacing or other exceptions apply; the AAA level raises it to 44×44. Focus Not Obscured (Minimum) is AA. Focus Appearance is AAA and asks for a 3:1 change between focused and unfocused states	Use 44 px for touch targets and 24 px as an absolute floor. Sticky header and bottom bar must never cover a focused element
2	W3C Technique C39 and SC 2.3.3 (w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/Techniques/css/C39.html)	Motion triggered by interaction should respect the prefers-reduced-motion setting	Every transition gets a reduced-motion variant; no parallax or scroll-linked motion

#	Source	Finding (paraphrased)	Implication for VIT Carpool (my recommendation)
3	GOV.UK Design System, Error message and Error summary components (design-system.service.gov.uk)	Show the error next to the field and in a summary at the top that links to each field; don't clear what the user typed; give screen readers an "Error:" prefix	Adopt for Offer-ride, Add-vehicle, schedule and alert forms; stop showing "Required" in red before interaction
4	Material 3 navigation guidance, as documented by SAP Fiori (sap.com/design-system)	A navigation bar suits two to five core destinations on compact screens; a rail suits three to seven on larger ones; don't use a bar for more than five	Five primary destinations: bottom bar on phones, top bar on desktop
5	Nielsen Norman Group on hidden navigation (nngroup.com/articles/hamburger-menus), as summarized by secondary sources	Hidden navigation is less discoverable and used less than visible navigation; a mix of a few visible items plus a menu does better than hiding everything. One secondary summary reports a 2016 study with slower task completion when navigation was hidden (about 39% slower on desktop, 15% on mobile): treat those figures as second-hand	Keep four or five destinations visible; put only rarely used items (Vehicles, Profile, Sign out) in the account menu

#	Source	Finding (paraphrased)	Implication for VIT Carpool (my recommendation)
6	Linear: “How we redesigned the Linear UI (part II)”, “Behind the latest design refresh”, and the March 2026 UI refresh changelog (linear.app)	Reduced visual noise and kept alignment; navigation chrome should recede so the task content stays in focus; fewer and smaller icons; fewer separators; headers, navigation and view controls made consistent across sections; theme colours generated in LCH rather than HSL	Make the header quiet; one page-header pattern everywhere; stop stacking icon + chip + border + shadow
7	Stripe, “Designing accessible color systems” (stripe.com/blog/accessible-color-systems)	Working in a perceptually uniform colour space lets palette steps give predictable contrast across hues	Build palette steps by lightness and test contrast in tooling instead of choosing hex values by eye
8	Vercel Geist documentation (vercel.com/geist)	The system is organised as foundations (colours, typography, “materials” = radii, fills, strokes, shadows, and a grid) plus components	Mirror that order: tokens, then materials, then components; keep materials few
9	IBM Carbon, loading pattern (carbondesignsystem.com/patterns/loading-pattern)	Use skeletons for container and data components such as lists, cards and tables; not for toasts, menus or modals; keep them brief; use inline indicators for actions	Skeleton rows for lists; inline spinner inside the button that was pressed; no full-page spinners

#	Source	Finding (paraphrased)	Implication for VIT Carpool (my recommendation)
10	BlaBlaCar, as described by strategy+business and the Northampton Saints partnership page	Trust is built from ratings, visible activity (last visit, rides offered), moderated information and complete profiles; drivers accept or decline requests; a price bracket keeps drivers from profiting	The closest analogue. Show driver activity, rating count, vehicle and member-since; keep the fuel-cost framing; don't overstate verification
11	Apple HIG values via third-party summaries	44×44 pt targets; text that scales with Dynamic Type; 4.5:1 text contrast; 11 pt minimum text	Body text 16 px, metadata at least 13 px, use rem so browser text scaling works

Durable principles (my synthesis, not a research finding)

1. One primary action per screen; everything else steps back.
2. Show what matters now (next trip, request waiting) before totals.
3. One shell, three widths, one header pattern.
4. Every object shows its **status and its next action**.
5. Prevent errors before explaining them; explain them where they happen.
6. Disclose progressively: summary first, details on demand.
7. Privacy by default: coarse locations until a request is accepted.
8. Plain language: no internal terms in user-facing text.

4. Three visual directions

	A. Quiet Utility (professional, minimal)	B. Night Ride (premium consumer mobility)	C. Campus Commons (modern campus community)
Philosophy	Content first; typography and spacing do the work; accent colour only for actions and selection	Bold, dark, high-contrast, map- and imagery-led	Warm, friendly, student-first, playful
Impression	Calm, competent, institutionally credible	Premium, urban, energetic	Approachable, informal
Palette	Off-white canvas, white surfaces, ink text, one deep blue; green/amber/red only for status	Near-black surfaces, white text, one electric accent	Warm off-white with coral, yellow and teal accents
Typography	One variable sans, tabular numerals	Bold geometric display plus sans	Rounded sans
Navigation	Top bar; bottom bar on phones	Bottom tab bar and large sheets	Tab bar with illustrated icons
Cards	Flat, 1 px border, 12 px radius, no shadow	Large dark cards, big radius	Soft pastel cards, large radius
Buttons	Solid primary, outline secondary, text tertiary, 8 px radius	Full pills, high contrast	Colourful pills
Forms	Labels above, 16 px text, visible borders	Dark inputs	Rounded, playful validation
Motion	120–200 ms fades and presses	Large sheet transitions	Bouncy micro-interactions

	A. Quiet Utility (professional, minimal)	B. Night Ride (premium consumer mobility)	C. Campus Commons (modern campus community)
Strengths	Credible to students and faculty alike; cheapest to build in the existing React app; best accessibility baseline; easy to extend	Distinctive; strong on phones	Memorable; warm for first-year students
Weaknesses	Can feel plain if details slip; identity depends on discipline	Reads as a ride-hailing imitation; needs a second light theme; neon accents struggle with contrast; feels commercial next to cost-sharing	Faculty may find it unserious; pastel contrast failures; many accent colours collide with status colours; high inconsistency risk
University fit	High	Medium-low	Medium for students, low for faculty

Scores (1–5, my judgment, not measurements)

Criterion	A	B	C
Professional credibility	5	3	2
Modernity	4	5	3
Ease of use	5	3	4
Trust	5	3	3
Accessibility	5	3	3
Brand distinctiveness	3	4	4
Desktop and mobile suitability	4	3	3
Practical in the existing React app	5	2	3
Total (of 40)	**36**	**26**	**25**

5. Recommended direction: Quiet Utility with a route spine

Why A. The audience is both students and faculty, the product's purpose is trust and safety, the money model is non-commercial cost sharing, and the budget is a solo developer. The current look is already light with a blue accent, so A is an evolution, not a rewrite, which keeps regression risk low. It is also the direction where accessibility is easiest to guarantee.

Where the identity comes from. A restrained system is not generic if it has a few signature devices, used consistently:

1. **Route spine:** a vertical line joining a filled dot (origin) and a ringed dot (destination), with the time beside each stop. It appears on every ride card, booking, schedule and alert, so users learn to read a trip at a glance.
2. **Seat dots:** ●●○ shows seats filled and open next to the "3 seats left" text.
3. **Tabular numerals** for times, prices and seats so columns line up when scanning.
4. **A deliberate accent:** one deep blue, used only for primary actions, selection and links; a single bolder moment in the home hero.
5. **Voice:** short, specific, friendly ("Ask for a seat", not "Submit booking request").

Borrowed, not copied. Linear's quiet chrome; Stripe's contrast discipline; GOV.UK's error pattern; BlaBlaCar's trust content. **Deliberately not adopted:** a black ride-hailing theme, stock photography, extreme letter-spacing, playful stickers. A dark theme is a P2 option that the token system makes possible later.

6. Design tokens and typography system

How tokens are used. Put every value below in one file (suggested: `src/styles/tokens.css`) as CSS custom properties, imported once at the app root. Components read tokens only: no hard-coded hex values or pixel sizes. If the app uses Tailwind, map the same names into the theme; if it uses plain CSS or CSS modules, use `var(--…)`. Token names are suggestions; the values matter. **All contrast pairs must be verified with a contrast checker and axe before merge**; ratios quoted here are approximate.

6.1 Colour

Token	Value	Use
`--brand-50`	#EEF3FF	Selected-row tint, info banner background
`--brand-100`	#DCE6FF	Hover tint on secondary controls
`--brand-600`	#2340B8	Primary button, links, selected nav, focus ring, origin dot (white text on it is roughly 8:1 by my calculation)
`--brand-700`	#1B3294	Primary hover; link hover
`--brand-800`	#152874	Primary pressed
`--canvas`	#F8F9FB	Page background
`--surface`	#FFFFFF	Cards, header, inputs
`--border-subtle`	#E5E7EB	Card borders and dividers (decorative)
`--border-control`	#7B8494	Input, select and checkbox borders; must reach 3:1 against the surface (verify)
`--text-primary`	#111827	Headings, key data
`--text-secondary`	#4B5563	Descriptions, metadata (about 7.5:1 on white)
`--text-tertiary`	#6B7280	Lowest allowed for text (about 4.8:1 on white); never on tinted backgrounds without checking
`--text-disabled`	#9CA3AF	Disabled controls only
`--success-600` / `--success-50`	#15803D / #ECFDF3	Confirmed, verified, completed
`--warning-700` / `--warning-50`	#92400E / #FFFAEB	Pending, needs attention

Token	Value	Use
`--danger-700` / `--danger-50` / `--danger-600`	#B42318 / #FEF3F2 / #D92D20	Errors, cancelled, destructive buttons (600 as button fill)

Rules for accent and status colour

1. Brand blue appears only on: primary buttons, links, the selected nav item or tab, the focus ring, and the origin dot of the route spine.
2. Success, warning and danger colours are for **status only**. They are never decoration and never colour a metric number. The current blue/green/purple numbers on the dashboard go away.
3. Colour is never the only signal: every status badge carries text and an icon.
4. No gradients, glassmorphism, blur, or floating decorative shapes in the app UI. The home hero uses a flat brand-50 band or no band.
5. Focus ring: 2 px solid brand-600 with a 2 px offset, on every focusable element (white on any dark surface).
6. When building the ramp, generate steps by perceptual lightness (as Stripe and Linear describe) rather than picking by eye, and keep the ramp in the token file so it can be regenerated.

6.2 Typography

Family. One family, **Inter (variable)**, self-hosted through `@fontsource-variable/inter` (one new dependency; it removes a third-party font request and gives tabular numerals, which matter for times, prices and seat counts). Fallback stack: `Inter Variable, system-ui, "Noto Sans Tamil", sans-serif`. Registration plates use `ui-monospace, SFMono-Regular, Menlo, monospace`. The current typeface looks like a geometric sans (possibly Plus Jakarta Sans); confirm in the CSS. Replacing it is low risk and optional if tabular figures are available.

Style	Size / line height	Weight	Where
Display	clamp(2rem, 1.4rem + 2.5vw, 3rem) / 1.1	700, −0.02em	Home hero only
Headline (h1)	1.75rem / 2.25rem (1.5rem / 2rem under 768 px)	600	One per page

Style	Size / line height	Weight	Where
Title (h2)	1.25rem / 1.75rem	600	Section headings
Subtitle	1.0625rem / 1.5rem	600	Card titles, place names
Body	1rem / 1.5rem	400	Default text; all form inputs (16 px prevents iOS zoom)
Body-small	0.875rem / 1.25rem	400	Secondary text in cards (the minimum for secondary information)
Label / button	0.875–0.9375rem / 1.25rem	500 / 600	Form labels, buttons, tabs
Caption	0.8125rem / 1.125rem	400 / 500	Timestamps and metadata; never below 13 px
Numeric	inherits; `font-variant-numeric: tabular-nums`	500–700	Times, prices, seat counts, badges with counts; price figure 1.5rem / 700

Rules. Sentence case everywhere: “LEAVING FROM” becomes “Leaving from”. No uppercase letter-spaced labels except badges of three letters or fewer. Only weights 400, 500, 600, 700. Maximum line length about 70 characters for paragraphs. Use `rem` so browser text scaling works; test at 200% zoom and at 320 px width.

6.3 Spacing and layout

Token	Value
Spacing scale (4 px base)	4, 8, 12, 16, 20, 24, 32, 40, 48, 64 (`--space-1` … `--space-10`)
Page gutter	16 px under 768; 24 px at 768–1023; 32 px at 1024 and above
Card padding	16 px mobile; 20 px from 768
Gap between list cards	12 px mobile; 16 px desktop
Gap between page sections	24 px mobile; 32 px desktop
Breakpoints (min-width)	480, 768, 1024, 1280

Token	Value
Header height	56 px mobile; 64 px desktop

Three content widths, no exceptions. Every page renders inside one `PageShell` component that takes `width="narrow | content | wide"`; pages never set their own max-width.

Width token	Value	Pages
`--w-narrow`	560 px (sign-in card 440 px)	Offer a ride, Add vehicle, schedule and alert forms, Sign-in, Profile
`--w-content`	880 px	My trips (bookings, driving, schedules, alerts), Vehicles, Notifications, Inbox list
`--w-wide`	1120 px	Home, Dashboard (two columns), Find rides (list plus optional map)

6.4 Materials

- **Radius:** 8 px for controls (buttons, inputs, selects); 12 px for cards; 16 px for dialogs and bottom sheets; full pill only for status badges and filter chips.
- **Borders:** 1 px `--border-subtle` on cards. Selected state is a 1 px brand-600 border plus brand-50 fill.
- **Shadows:** none on cards. One overlay shadow (`0 8px 24px rgb(17 24 39 / 12%)`) for menus, dialogs and sheets only.
- **No nested bordered boxes.** Inside a card, group with spacing or a divider, not another bordered or grey panel. This removes the double-border look in the search fields and the inner grey boxes on ride cards.
- **Icons:** one set (keep the current line icons), 20 px default, 16 px inline, consistent stroke. Icon-only buttons need an accessible name.

6.5 Brand language: replace internal wording

Current text	Replace with
“PLATFORM PREVIEW”, “(Planned)”, “(Design Requirement)”, “Preview driver publishing”	Remove. State only behaviour that is live; for example, don’t claim institutional verification until the admin review flow is live in production
“ARCHITECTURAL REQUIREMENT & SECURITY DESIGN”	“Students ride with students. Faculty ride with faculty.”
“Strict STUDENT cohort isolation active”, “Isolated STUDENT Network”, “Campus Audience”	A quiet chip: “Student community” or “Faculty community”, with the explanation in the Safety page
“Published Rides”	“Rides you’re offering”
“Directional matching enforced”	“Only rides heading your way”
“Fuel Contribution”	“Fuel share” (per seat)
“MANUAL_ID_REVIEW”	“Verified by ID review” (map every enum to a label)
“Quick Ride · 1-Click”	“Repeat a ride”
“View All →”, “Manage →”	Specific labels: “See all bookings”, “Manage rides”
“My Bookings (Passenger)”	“Bookings” (the section title already says whose they are)

7. Navigation and information architecture

Problem solved. Ten top-level links overflow and give equal weight to daily tasks (find, offer, check requests) and rarely used ones (vehicles). The proposal keeps all functionality and all existing URLs.

7.1 Primary navigation (five destinations)

#	Destination	Contains	Existing routes (unchanged)
1	**Home**	Role-aware dashboard	/dashboard (logo links to Home)
2	**Find a ride**	Search and results	/rides
3	**Offer a ride**	Publish form	/offer-ride
4	**My trips**	Segmented tabs: **Bookings**, **Driving**, **Schedules**, **Alerts**	/bookings, /my-rides, /recurring-commutes, /ride-alerts
5	**Inbox**	Segmented tabs: **Messages**, **Updates** with one combined unread badge	/messages, /notifications

Avatar menu (top right): Profile, Vehicles, Safety and privacy (the existing explanation page), Sign out (last, separated by a divider). Vehicles lives here because it is set up once; it is also linked contextually from Offer a ride (“Add a vehicle”) and from the Driving tab.

Why one “My trips” hub. Bookings (as passenger), Driving (as driver), Schedules (recurring commutes) and Alerts are one mental model, “the trips I’ve arranged”, seen from different angles. They become tabs in a shared layout; each page keeps its URL, so this is a layout wrapper (a nested layout route), not a rewrite.

7.2 Desktop header (1024 px and above)

One row, 64 px high, never wrapping (`white-space: nowrap`): logo mark and “VIT Carpool” wordmark on one line (the “VIT CHENNAI CAMPUS” tagline moves out of the header); then Home, Find a ride, My trips, Inbox as text links (15 px / 500, 12 px horizontal padding); on the right a **primary “Offer a ride” button**, the avatar menu, and the Inbox badge on the Inbox link. The selected item uses `aria-current="page"`, weight 600 and a 2 px underline in brand-600, not colour alone.

7.3 Phones and tablets (under 1024 px)

- **Bottom bar with five items:** Home, Find, Offer, Trips, Inbox. Icon 24 px plus a 12 px label; 56 px high plus the device safe-area inset; every target at least 44 px. Offer uses a filled brand icon so it reads as the main action, without a floating button.
- **Top bar:** logo at left, avatar menu at right, page title beneath (not duplicated in the bar).

- Pages add bottom padding equal to the bar height so content and focused fields are never covered (WCAG 2.2 Focus Not Obscured).
- Segmented tabs (Trips, Inbox) sit under the page header and scroll horizontally only if they cannot fit.

7.4 Signed-out navigation

Logo, How it works, Safety, and a single primary **Sign in** button. Remove the plain-text "Offer a Ride" link. On the sign-in page, remove the duplicate label: the card keeps the Sign in / Create account tabs; the header button is hidden there.

7.5 Page header pattern (every page)

H1 at left; **at most one primary action** at right; one line of description in `--text-secondary`; optional segmented tabs below. Example: "Driving" with a primary "Offer a ride" button. No page uses a card as its header. The marketing footer does not appear inside the signed-in app; legal and help links move to the Profile page. Marketing pages (Home signed-out, How it works, Safety) get a slim light footer instead of the dark navy block.

7.6 Role awareness

No separate driver and passenger modes in the navigation: everyone sees the same five items, which is simpler and matches users who both drive and ride (as the sample account does). Role shows up inside pages: the dashboard leads with whichever applies (next trip as passenger, rides to drive, requests waiting), Offer a ride prompts for a vehicle when none exists, and the empty Driving tab invites a first ride rather than showing zeros.

8. Page-by-page redesign specifications

Every page uses: `PageShell` (width token from 6.3), the page header pattern (7.5), the shared components in Section 9, and the three data states (loading skeleton, empty, error with retry). Priority tags: **P0** essential, **P1** high impact, **P2** refinement. Items marked *optional* would need a backend capability I cannot confirm exists; the rest use data the screenshots already show.

8.1 Home (signed-out marketing page) — P0 copy, P1 layout

- **Goal:** a visitor understands the value in five seconds and starts a search or signs in.

- **Most important information:** what it is, who it is for, how to start, why it is safe.
- **Layout (wide):** hero with the search bar, then “How it works”, then “Safety and trust”, then a slim light footer.
- **Hero copy (proposal):** H1 “Share the ride to campus.” Subhead “VIT Chennai students and faculty heading your way. Split the fuel, skip the solo drive.” Add the word “verified” only if verification is live in production.
- **Search bar:** one bordered container with four fields separated by dividers (no input-inside-box). Labels above the fields in sentence case (“Leaving from”, “Going to”, “Date”, “Seats”), a swap icon button between the two places with an accessible name, and a primary “Find rides” button. Under it, one text link: “Driving to campus? Offer a ride”. Date has `min` = today. A signed-out search sends the visitor to sign-in and returns them to the results with the search preserved.
- **How it works:** three numbered steps (Find or offer a ride → Ask for a seat → Driver confirms, you ride). Text and the route spine only; no stock photography.
- **Safety and trust (only true statements):** students ride with students and faculty with faculty; drivers approve every request; cars only; fuel sharing only, no fares or profit; ratings after rides. Add “exact addresses stay private until your seat is confirmed” **only after confirming that behaviour is real**.
- **Remove:** PLATFORM PREVIEW badge, (Planned) and (Design Requirement) chips, the “ARCHITECTURAL REQUIREMENT” label, “Preview driver publishing”, the dark footer.
- **Signed-in behaviour:** “/” redirects to the dashboard; the logo links there.
- **Mobile:** From and To stacked with the swap button on the right edge; Date and Seats side by side; full-width button.
- **States:** inline validation (“Enter where you’re leaving from”); button shows an inline spinner while redirecting.

8.2 Sign-in and registration — P0 (dev gating), P1 (layout)

- **Goal:** get in with a VIT email in under 30 seconds.
- **Layout (narrow card, 440 px):** segmented control “Sign in | Create account”, email field labelled “VIT email” with the hint “We’ll email you a 6-digit code. No password.”, primary button “Email me a code”.
- **Step two:** a single code input (`autocomplete="one-time-code"` , `inputmode="numeric"`), a “Resend code” link with a visible countdown, “Use a different email”, and clear messages for a wrong, expired or rate-limited code.

- **Placeholder:** don't presume a domain (the current placeholder uses vitstudent.ac.in, which hasn't been confirmed with VIT). Use the hint "Use your VIT Chennai email".
- **P0, security:** the "Local Dev Fast-Fill (Test Accounts)" control must be compiled out of production builds (guard with the build-time dev flag) and any backend route it relies on must be disabled in production. Verify this regardless of how the UI looks.
- **Registration:** adds the category claim (student or faculty) and ends on a **verification status screen**: Pending ("We're checking your details. You'll get an email."), Verified, Rejected (with a reason and a contact route), Suspended. Users in Pending can see the app's explanatory pages but cannot search or book.
- **Remove:** the duplicate "Sign In / Sign Up" header button on this page, the dark footer.

8.3 Dashboard — P0

- **Goal:** answer "what do I need to do, and where do I need to be next?"
- **Layout (wide; two columns from 1024 px, main 2fr and aside 1fr):**
  1. **Greeting** with first name and a quiet community chip.
  2. **Next trip** card: the soonest upcoming item, either a confirmed booking as passenger or a ride you are driving. Shows role ("You're driving" / "You're a passenger"), the route spine with time, status badge, and actions (Message, Details, overflow).
  3. **Needs your attention** (rendered only when non-empty, capped at three with "See all"): requests waiting on your rides with **Accept / Decline inline** (same actions as the bookings page); bookings awaiting a driver's reply (information only); completed rides you haven't rated.
  4. **Coming up:** the next five items grouped by date.
  5. Aside: "Rides you're offering" (next three, drivers only) or a "Find a ride" prompt (passengers only); alert count and link only when above zero.
- **Remove:** the six metric cards, "Campus Audience", the email line, the isolation sentence, and the role label from the name.
- **Role awareness:** a user counts as a driver if they have a vehicle or have offered a ride. Drivers see the offering module; passengers see the prompt; users who are both see both, ordered by what is soonest.
- **Mobile:** single column in the same order; actions become full-width buttons.
- **States:** skeletons per module (a failure in one module doesn't blank the page); empty "Next trip" shows Find / Offer buttons; error shows "Couldn't load your trips" with a Retry button.

- **Data note:** “next” excludes anything whose departure time has passed (see Section 13 about stale bookings).

8.4 Find rides — P0

- **Goal:** compare options and ask for a seat in a few taps.
- **Layout (wide):** a compact **search summary bar** (From → To · Date · Seats · Edit) that expands into the full form; a **Filters** row (desktop chips; bottom sheet on mobile) for Time of day, Max price, Seats and Sort (Earliest, Lowest price; “Closest pickup” only if the API returns distance); results header “8 rides · Thu 29 Oct” with a “Students only” chip. Results are a **single-column list** (about 720 px) so times and prices can be compared down the page; a map column is an optional P2.
- **New ride card:** left, the departure time (tabular numerals) over a route spine with origin and destination; right, the fuel share (“₹100”, “per seat”); second row: driver avatar, first name, ★ 5.0 (12); the vehicle in one line (“White Maruti Swift”); seat dots with “3 seats left”. One primary button, **“Request seat”** (44 px). The whole card opens a details view with pickup points, driver summary, vehicle and rules.
- **Request flow:** a sheet showing the summary, a seats stepper, an optional note, “Send request”. On success: “Request sent. Kavya will reply; you’ll get an update.” with links to Bookings and Find more rides. Double-tap protection through the button’s loading state.
- **Own rides:** should not appear in a passenger’s results. If the API returns them, filter them out on the client as a stopgap and confirm the rule with the team; if you decide to keep them, label them “Your ride” and replace the button with “View ride”.
- **Remove:** three-column grid, uppercase labels, nested chips, the “Isolated STUDENT Network” badge.
- **Pagination:** “Showing 8 of 29” needs a visible “Load more” button (or numbered pages); never truncate silently.
- **States:** four skeleton cards; empty “No rides match yet” with primary “Create an alert for this route” and secondary “Change date” and “Reset filters”; error banner with Retry that keeps the search.
- **Mobile:** sticky summary bar under the header; filters in a bottom sheet with Apply and Clear; button full width.

8.5 Offer a ride — P0/P1

- **Goal:** publish a ride in under a minute, especially a repeat of an earlier one.

- **Layout (narrow, one column, no cards inside cards).** Sections with H2 headings:
  1. **Start from** (shown only if the user has history): segmented control “Repeat last ride | Saved route | New route” that prefills the form below. This replaces the Quick Ride / Custom Ride tabs, so there is always one visible form.
  2. **Route:** Leaving from, Going to, swap button; “Add a pickup point” collapsed by default.
  3. **When:** Date and Time, both empty by default (not prefilled with the current time); quick chips (“In 30 min”, “Tomorrow 8:00”) as secondary helpers; the time zone as a hint (“India Standard Time”), not in the label.
  4. **Vehicle and seats:** vehicle select (with “Add a vehicle” link), seats stepper limited to the vehicle’s passenger capacity.
  5. **Fuel share:** price per seat in ₹ with a hint (“Cost sharing only: fuel and tolls”), plus any server-side limit stated up front.
  6. **Repeat:** switch “Repeat on weekdays” reveals days and an end date and creates a schedule (*optional if this isn’t supported inline; otherwise link to New schedule*).
  7. **Review:** a summary row (route spine, time, seats, price) and the primary **“Publish ride”** button.
- **Validation:** follow the GOV.UK pattern: no error text until the user has interacted or submitted; on submit, an error summary at the top linking to each field, plus a message next to each field; typed values are never cleared. The submit button is not disabled.
- **Success:** a confirmation panel with the route spine and three actions: View ride, Offer another, Repeat on weekdays.
- **Remove:** “Required for new ride” in red before interaction; the 1-Click badge; the two-tab structure.
- **Data note:** “Saved Commute Routes (8)” showing two pills needs checking (Section 13).

8.6 Driving (driver ride management, route /my-rides) — P0

- **Goal:** answer requests and see the next departures.
- **Header:** “Driving”, primary “Offer a ride”, My trips tabs below.
- **Requests waiting panel** (only if above zero): rows with passenger first name and rating, seats asked, requested pickup, the ride’s time, and **Accept / Decline** buttons. This replaces the amber banner that sent drivers to another page. Accepting or declining updates the row in place with a confirmation line and an Undo only if the backend supports it (otherwise, none).
- **Filters:** Upcoming | Past | Cancelled, counts shown as muted numbers.

- **Upcoming list grouped by date** (Today, Tomorrow, then dates). **Recurring rides are grouped:** one expandable row per schedule ("Mon–Fri · 8:00 am · Tambaram → VIT Main Gate · next 10 rides") that opens into date rows. Each ride row: date and time, compact route spine, seat dots with "0 of 3 booked", a warning badge "2 requests" when applicable, and an overflow menu (View, Cancel ride). "Cancel ride" opens a confirmation dialog that states the consequence (for example "2 passengers will be told") only if the system actually notifies them.
- **Remove:** the driver's own rating on their own rides; the grey inner box; the repeated ₹100 on every card (show it once in the schedule row).
- **Data note:** grouping needs a series identifier and service date on each ride. The earlier schema had both; confirm the API exposes them, and don't group by guessing from route and time.
- **Mobile:** rows are full width; the overflow menu opens as a bottom sheet.
- **States:** skeleton rows; empty "You're not offering any rides yet" with an Offer button; error with Retry.

8.7 Bookings (passenger view, route /bookings) — P0

- **Goal:** know the status of each seat request and what to do next.
- **Layout (content width):** header "Bookings"; filters **Upcoming | Past**. The existing "Driver Requests" tab moves into the Driving page (8.6); keep it reachable at its current address for compatibility, and show a banner here when the user has requests to answer ("2 people asked for seats on your rides. Review").
- **Booking card:** line one is the status badge with the date and time ("Tue 27 Oct · 3:37 pm"); then the route spine; then driver first name with rating and the fuel share (₹50); then a **next-action line that depends on the state**:

State	Message	Actions
Pending	"Waiting for Kavya to reply."	Message driver (secondary); Cancel request (tertiary, confirm)
Confirmed	"You're in. Pickup: Tambaram Railway Station."	Message driver (primary); Cancel booking (tertiary, confirm dialog that states the consequence)
Declined	"Not accepted." (muted)	Find similar rides

State	Message	Actions
Cancelled	“Cancelled by you / by the driver.” (muted)	Find similar rides
Completed	“Rate your ride with Kavya.”	Rate (primary) if not yet rated; otherwise “Rated 5/5” as plain text
Expired (if the backend has this state)	“Request expired.”	Find similar rides

- **Contact:** replace “Confirmed Driver Contact: …” with “Driver: Kavya”; show a phone number only if the product shares it after confirmation.
- **Stale state:** if a booking is Pending or Confirmed after its departure time, do **not** paper over it in the UI. It is a data/state question (Section 13).
- **Mobile:** stacked card; the two buttons sit side by side at full width; confirm dialogs become bottom sheets.
- **States:** skeleton cards; empty “No bookings yet” with Find a ride; error with Retry.

8.8 Schedules (recurring commutes, route /recurring-commutes) — P1

- **Goal:** set a commute once, see that it is running, and pause, edit or end it.
- **Header:** “Schedules” with primary “New schedule” (remove the filled “My Schedules (1)” button). Filters Active | Paused | Ended with counts, shown only when there are two or more schedules.
- **Layout:** full-width rows (content width), not narrow cards, to remove the empty page area and the three-line route wrapping. Each row: route spine; “Mon–Fri · 8:00 am”; date range in the app’s format (“28 Oct – 27 Nov”, not 2026-10-28); vehicle and ₹100 per seat; a status badge (Active green, Paused amber, Ended grey).
- **Status line (explain what the state means):** Active “Next ride Fri 30 Oct · 10 rides scheduled”. Paused “Paused. No new rides will be added; 10 rides already scheduled stay open.” **Confirm the real behaviour with the backend before writing this sentence.**
- **Actions:** one state-appropriate primary (Resume when paused, Pause when active), Edit, and an overflow with “End schedule” (confirm dialog listing consequences for scheduled rides and booked passengers). “10 rides scheduled” links to the Driving tab.

- **Form (narrow):** Route; Days as toggle chips with accessible names plus a “Weekdays” shortcut; Time; Vehicle and seats; Fuel share; Start and end dates; a note “Rides are created 14 days ahead”. Editing shows a warning about effects on existing rides and bookings.
- **Empty:** “Drive the same route every week? Set it once and the rides post themselves.” with a New schedule button.
- **Mobile:** rows stack; actions sit under the status line.

8.9 Alerts (ride alerts, route /ride-alerts) — P1

- **Goal:** say which route and time you need and be told when a ride matches.
- **Header:** “Alerts”, description “We’ll tell you when a ride matches”, primary “New alert”. Remove the separate “Notification Inbox” button; Inbox is in the main navigation.
- **Row:** route spine; time window (“Weekdays 7:30–9:00 am” or, when unspecified, “Any time” in muted text with a nudge “Add a time window for better matches”); distance as plain words (“Within 5 km of pickup”); seats; an **Active/Paused switch** (instant, no confirmation, announced as “Alert on” / “Alert off”); Edit; Delete in the overflow with a confirm dialog.
- **Remove:** the “Directional matching enforced” line (replace with “Only rides heading your way” in the form’s help text).
- **Duplicates:** when creating an alert identical to an existing one, show “You already have this alert” with a link to it. Preventing duplicates on the server is the real fix (*optional backend change*). A client-side “Possible duplicates” banner with a bulk delete is a P2.
- **Form (narrow):** Route; When (one date, or weekdays); time window From and To; distance select (1, 2, 5 km; confirm the intended default); minimum seats.
- **Optional:** “Last matched 2 days ago” on each row, if the API provides it.
- **Empty:** “Can’t find a ride? Create an alert and we’ll tell you when one appears.”

8.10 Vehicles — P1

- **Goal:** keep accurate vehicle details so drivers can offer rides.
- **Header:** “Vehicles” with primary “Add vehicle”. Shrink the large blue policy banner to one line under the header (“Cars only”) with a “Why?” disclosure.
- **Card (two columns from 768 px, list on mobile):** make and model as subtitle; colour; the registration number in a monospace pill, formatted for reading; capacity as **“4 passenger seats”** (use one unit everywhere; confirm whether the stored value is total or passenger seats, because the sample shows 4, 4 and 5 for similar cars); a

verification badge (Verified, In review, Needs changes). The copy says only verified cars are eligible, so the state should be visible; if the backend has no such state, say nothing rather than invent one.

- **Actions:** Edit (secondary) and an overflow with Delete (confirm dialog; warn if upcoming rides use the vehicle).
- **Form (narrow):** Make and model; Colour; Registration number (uppercased, spaces stripped, an **advisory** format hint such as “TN 19 AA 5001”; the server stays authoritative; check whether the newer Bharat series format must be accepted before enforcing a pattern); Passenger seats stepper (1–6). Error text: “Enter a registration like TN 19 AA 5001”.
- **Data note:** “INVALID123” is demonstration data. Seed and demo vehicles must live only in development databases.
- **Empty:** “Add the car you’ll drive” with an explanation of why it is needed.

8.11 Messages (route /messages) — P1

- **Goal:** coordinate pickup for one specific ride.
- **Desktop (wide):** two panes. Left, the conversation list (about 340 px); right, the thread.
- **List row:** initials avatar, first name, a caption with the ride (“Tambaram → VIT · Tue 27 Oct 4:01 pm”), a one-line preview, the time at the right, and an unread dot with bold text. Drop the “PASSENGER” chip (show it in the thread header if needed). Sort by latest activity.
- **Thread:** header with the name, a “View ride” link, and an overflow for Report and Block (these exist in the product’s safety features); messages grouped by day with timestamps; a composer fixed at the bottom with an auto-growing text area (Enter sends, Shift+Enter adds a line), a loading state while sending, and a failed state with Retry. A one-line safety note under the composer.
- **Mobile:** the list is a full screen; tapping a row opens the thread full screen with a back button; the bottom bar hides inside a thread so the composer sits above the keyboard.
- **States:** empty “No conversations yet. They start when you ask for or accept a seat.”; skeleton rows; error with Retry. Don’t invent real-time behaviour: if the app polls or uses a Refresh button, keep that and show “Updated just now”.
- **Duplicate-looking conversations** (14 identical rows) must be diagnosed as a data or interaction issue, separately from styling. See Section 13, item 1, for the steps. Do not de-duplicate in the UI until the cause is known.

8.12 Notifications / Updates (route /notifications) — P1

- **Goal:** see what changed and act on it.
- **Layout (content width):** an Inbox tab strip (Messages | Updates) with a combined badge; a filter All | Unread whose counts always match what is shown; a “Mark all as read” link when anything is unread; items grouped by day (Today, Yesterday, date).
- **Row:** a type icon (booking, alert, schedule) in a neutral tile, a title **without emoji**, one or two lines of body text, the time at the right; unread = bold title, a small brand dot and a brand-50 background (and the same logic drives the badge and the Unread count); one specific link (“Review request” opening that booking) in place of the two generic “View Rides / View Bookings” links, if the notification carries a booking id; dismiss in an overflow.
- **Behaviour:** mark as read when the item is opened.
- **Empty:** “You’re all caught up.”
- **Data note:** unread dots with “Unread (0)” and several same-text notifications minutes apart need checking (Section 13).

8.13 Profile — P1

- **Goal:** see and manage identity, verification, reputation and privacy.
- **Layout (narrow):** header (avatar, name, a “Student community” chip, a verification badge “Verified by ID review·since 25 Oct 2026”); **Account** (email, member since); **Reputation** (average, count, then recent reviews with reviewer first name, date, stars and comment, “Show more”); **Privacy** (what others see about you and what they don’t; state only what is true); **Session** (Sign out).
- **Verification states:** Pending, Rejected and Suspended show an explanatory banner with the next step instead of the green badge.
- **Remove:** the raw enum, the long title “Account & Institutional Profile” (use “Profile”).
- **Data note:** twelve identical reviews from one reviewer look like seed data; check before showing real users (Section 13).

8.14 Pages not in the screenshots — P2 until reviewed

Admin and moderation, reports, blocking, verification review, and any ride-details or safety pages were not shown. They should adopt `PageShell`, the status badge, dialogs and the table pattern, but I don’t specify layouts for screens I haven’t seen. Share screenshots and I’ll extend this section. Two rules apply to all of them: suspensions and

other destructive moderation actions use a confirmation dialog that names the account and the consequence, and moderation tables keep the same status badge language as the rest of the product.

9. Reusable component inventory

Rule of thumb. A component is *shared* if two or more pages need it; otherwise it stays page-specific and is composed from shared parts. Don't build a component library ahead of need: build each shared component the first time a phase needs it.

9.1 Shared components

Component	Variants and sizes	Notes
`PageShell`	width: narrow, content, wide	Applies gutters, max-width, bottom padding for the mobile bar. No page sets its own width
`AppHeader`, `BottomNav`, `AccountMenu`	desktop header; mobile bar; menu	Section 7. Badges announce counts ("Inbox, 4 unread")
`PageHeader`	title, description, one primary action	One H1 per page
`SegmentedTabs`	tabs with optional counts	ARIA tabs pattern, arrow-key navigation; used for My trips, Inbox, filters
`Button`	primary, secondary, tertiary (text), destructive; md 44 px, sm 36 px (desktop only)	Loading state shows an inline spinner and keeps the width; the button is not disabled for validation
`IconButton`	44 px target (visual may be 36)	Always has an accessible name
`TextField`, `Select`, `DateField`, `TimeField`	label above, optional hint, error	16 px text; border meets 3:1; label and hint linked with `aria-describedby`

Component	Variants and sizes	Notes
`Stepper`	seats, passenger capacity	Minus/plus buttons with a visible number; announced value
`Switch`	alert on/off	Instant action; role switch
`ChipToggle`	weekdays, filter chips	Pressed state is not colour only (check mark)
`SearchBar`	full form; compact summary	Used on Home and Find rides
`Card`	flat, optionally selectable	Border and radius only; no nested bordered boxes
`RouteSpine`	full (two places, times); compact (one line)	The signature element; used on every trip
`SeatDots`	filled and open	Always paired with text (“3 seats left”)
`StatusBadge`	see 9.3	Icon plus text plus tint
`Avatar`, `RatingInline`	initials; ★ 5.0 (12)	Rating hidden when count is zero
`Alert`	info, success, warning, error	For page-level messages; `role="status"` or `role="alert"` as appropriate
`ErrorSummary`	list of links to fields	GOV.UK pattern; focus moves to it on submit
`Toast`	success, error	Live region; auto-dismiss only for success; never the only place an error appears
`ConfirmDialog`, `Dialog`, `BottomSheet`	dialog on desktop; sheet under 768 px	Focus trap, Escape closes, focus returns to the trigger
`OverflowMenu`	row actions	Keyboard operable; destructive items last and in danger colour

Component	Variants and sizes	Notes
`Skeleton`	row, card	Only for list and card content; reduced-motion safe
`EmptyState`, `ErrorState`	title, one sentence, one primary action	Route-spine line art made in CSS, no images
`LoadMore`	button with count	“Showing 8 of 29”
`ListRow`	leading, content, trailing	Base for notifications, conversations, schedules, alerts

9.2 Page-specific components (composed from the above)

`RideCard` (Find rides), `RequestSeatSheet`, `BookingCard`, `RequestRow` (Accept / Decline), `ScheduleRow`, `AlertRow`, `VehicleCard`, `ConversationList` and `ChatThread`, `NotificationRow`, `NextTripCard` and `AttentionList` (Dashboard), `VerificationStatus` (post-registration).

9.3 Status badge language

Domain	Status	Label	Tint	Icon
Booking	Pending	Pending	warning	clock
Booking	Confirmed	Confirmed	success	check
Booking	Declined / Expired	Declined / Expired	neutral	x / clock-off
Booking	Cancelled	Cancelled	neutral	ban
Booking	Completed	Completed	neutral	check-circle
Ride	Scheduled / Cancelled / Completed	Upcoming / Cancelled / Completed	brand / neutral / neutral	calendar / ban / check
Schedule	Active / Paused / Ended	Active / Paused / Ended	success / warning / neutral	repeat / pause / stop

Domain	Status	Label	Tint	Icon
Vehicle	Verified / In review / Needs changes	same	success / warning / danger	shield-check / clock / alert
Account	Pending / Verified / Rejected / Suspended	same	warning / success / danger / danger	clock / shield-check / x / ban

Badge: pill, 13 px / 500 text, 24 px high, tinted background with the 700 text colour, icon 14 px. These exact labels are used everywhere the status appears.

9.4 Interaction states (all interactive components)

State	Behaviour
Default	Token colours; target at least 44 px on touch
Hover (pointer only)	Primary: brand-700. Secondary: brand-50 fill. Rows and cards: background to canvas tone. Never rely on hover to reveal essential actions
Focus-visible	2 px brand-600 ring, 2 px offset; never removed; not hidden by sticky bars
Active / pressed	Primary: brand-800; slight 1 px translate is optional and disabled under reduced motion
Disabled	`--text-disabled` on a neutral fill, `aria-disabled` or `disabled`; used only when an action is genuinely unavailable, with a visible reason nearby. **Not used to block form submission**: submit and show errors instead
Loading	Inline spinner replaces the icon or sits before the label; width is fixed; button ignores repeat clicks; announces “Sending…” to screen readers
Success	Inline confirmation text or toast with a check icon; the changed object updates in place
Error	Message next to the field and in the error summary; red border plus icon plus text; the user’s input is preserved

9.5 Dependencies

Add as few as possible. (1) `@fontsource-variable/inter`: self-hosted font. (2) **Only if not already present**, accessible primitives for dialog, tabs, menu and switch (Radix UI primitives or React Aria): they provide focus trapping and keyboard behaviour that is easy to get wrong by hand; a native `<dialog>` is an alternative for dialogs. Avoid adopting a full visual component library (it would fight the token system). Dev-only: Playwright with `@axe-core/playwright` for visual and accessibility checks (Section 14).

10. Responsive behaviour

Breakpoints are mobile-first (480, 768, 1024, 1280). Design and test at **320, 375, 768, 1024, 1280 and 1440 px**; nothing may scroll horizontally at 320 px (WCAG reflow).

Area	Phone (under 768)	Tablet (768–1023)	Laptop and desktop (1024 and above)
Navigation	Bottom bar (5) plus top bar with avatar menu	Same bottom bar; content uses its width token, centred	Single-row top header with text links and the Offer button
Search	Home: stacked fields, Date and Seats paired. Find rides: sticky summary bar that opens a full-screen editor	Home: two rows of fields. Find rides: summary bar	Home: one row of four fields. Find rides: summary bar expanding inline
Filters	Bottom sheet with Apply and Clear; active filters shown as removable chips	Chips row that wraps	Chips row; popovers for price and time
Ride cards	Full width; time and price on the first row; button full width	Full width list, button inline right	List (about 720 px) with optional map column
Booking and driver management	Stacked cards; two buttons side by side; overflow opens a bottom sheet	Same, with content width	Rows with actions at the right
Messages	List and thread are separate screens with a back button; bottom bar hidden in a thread	Two panes if width allows (list 300 px), else as phone	Two panes (list about 340 px)

Area	Phone (under 768)	Tablet (768–1023)	Laptop and desktop (1024 and above)
Forms	One column; 16 px fields; error summary at the top; bottom bar remains visible below the content	One column, narrow width centred	One column, narrow width centred (do not stretch fields)
Dialogs	Bottom sheets	Centred dialog	Centred dialog
Tables (admin)	Convert rows to stacked key–value cards	Horizontal scroll inside a container	Normal table

Rules. Don’t simply stack desktop components: each row above is a deliberate pattern change. Touch targets are at least 44 px; spacing between adjacent targets at least 8 px. Respect the device safe area (`env(safe-area-inset-*)`). Long place names truncate with an ellipsis and are available in full (tooltip on desktop, details view on mobile); they never wrap into three lines. Test with browser text at 200% and with long Tamil or English names.

11. Accessibility requirements

The target is WCAG 2.2 Level AA, with AAA target size (44 px) where practical. Each item below is testable.

1. **Semantics.** One H1 per page, headings in order; landmarks (`header` , `nav` , `main` , `footer`); lists marked up as lists; buttons for actions and links for navigation. Add a “Skip to main content” link.
2. **Keyboard.** Every journey (search → request a seat; offer a ride; accept a request; cancel a booking; sign in) works with the keyboard alone, with a logical tab order and no traps. Menus and dialogs follow standard key behaviour (Escape, arrow keys, focus return).
3. **Focus.** Visible 2 px ring with a 3:1 contrast change; sticky header and bottom bar never fully cover a focused control (use `scroll-padding` equal to the bar heights).
4. **Labels and names.** Every field has a visible, associated label; placeholders are examples, not labels; icon-only buttons (chat, bell, delete) have accessible names; counts are announced (“Inbox, 4 unread”).

5. **Errors.** Follow the GOV.UK pattern: summary at the top with links, message next to each field, an “Error:” prefix for screen readers, input preserved, focus moves to the summary on submit.
6. **Status messages.** Success and loading messages go in a `role="status"` live region; blocking errors use `role="alert"`.
7. **Colour and contrast.** Text 4.5:1 (large text 3:1); control borders, focus rings and icons that carry meaning 3:1; status never by colour alone. Verify every token pair; run axe in CI.
8. **Targets.** At least 44 px on touch; never below 24 px with spacing exceptions only where the WCAG rule allows.
9. **Text.** Browser zoom to 200% and a 320 px viewport cause no loss of content or function; text uses `rem`; line height at least 1.5 for body text.
10. **Motion.** Honour `prefers-reduced-motion` for every transition and animation (Section 12). No autoplay, no parallax.
11. **Forms.** Use the right input types and `autocomplete` values (`email`, `one-time-code`); numeric fields use `inputmode`; date and time fields keep native pickers but show the expected format as a hint.
12. **Language.** `lang` set on the document; plain wording; no jargon (Section 6.5).

12. Interaction and motion guidelines

Principle. Motion explains cause and effect (something opened, saved or moved). It never decorates. Total motion budget per interaction: 200 ms or less, except skeleton shimmer.

Interaction	Motion	Duration / easing	Reduced-motion variant
Hover and press on buttons and rows	Colour change (and optional 1 px press)	120 ms, ease-out	Colour change only
Menu, popover	Fade and 4 px rise	150 ms, ease-out	Fade only
Dialog	Fade; sheet slides up 16 px	200 ms, ease-out	Fade only
Skeleton	Soft shimmer across rows	1.2 s loop, low contrast	Static grey blocks

Interaction	Motion	Duration / easing	Reduced-motion variant
Seat request sent	Button spinner, then a check icon and confirmation text	200 ms	Same without any movement
Accept / Decline	Row updates in place and fades its action area	150 ms	Instant change
Page change	None (no page transitions)	n/a	n/a
Route spine	Static; the only optional flourish is the destination ring filling when a ride is confirmed	300 ms once	Static

Two forms of feedback matter more than animation: **immediate acknowledgement** (the button changes state within 100 ms of the press) and **clear outcome** (what happened and what happens next).

13. Known visual issues versus possible functional or data issues

Visual issues are observable in the screenshots and are fixed by this blueprint. The items below are **hypotheses**: they might be test data, a missing job, a missing constraint, or a real defect. Verify each before polishing the screens it affects, and **fix causes at the source, never by hiding rows in the UI**.

#	What the screenshots show	Class	Possible causes	How to verify
1	Messages: 14 conversations, all “Priya Passenger”, same route, same message	Data or interaction	(a) A seed script created them. (b) A conversation is created per booking request and the same passenger asked many times. (c) No uniqueness on ride + passenger + driver. (d) The list appends on refresh, duplicating state. (e) Rows are distinct but look alike because they omit the ride date	**Network tab:** open the conversations response. If it has fewer than 14 items, it is a UI state bug (check React keys and refresh logic). If it has 14 items with distinct ride ids, they are distinct conversations that need the ride date shown. If ride ids repeat, query the database (group by ride and participants, count above one), then check the creation path and add a unique constraint

#	What the screenshots show	Class	Possible causes	How to verify
2	Notifications: “Priya Passenger requested 1 seat” at 11:23, 11:25 and 11:26 pm	Data or idempotency	Repeated requests by a test script; double-submit; no dedupe key	Check the bookings for those notifications: different rides means legitimate; the same ride means the active-booking uniqueness is missing or bypassed. Check whether notifications carry a dedupe key
3	Unread dots on every card, “Unread (0)”, no badge on the bell, a badge of 4 on chat	State	Counts computed from different fields; the badge counts messages only; dots drawn by type rather than read state	Compare the API’s unread count with each item’s read timestamp; define one rule and use it for dots, tabs and badges
4	Bookings Pending and Confirmed for departures on 27 Oct, seen on 29 Oct	State	Expire and complete jobs not running locally; time-zone mismatch (IST vs UTC)	Check the job runner’s logs and the database status versus departure time. If the jobs run in production, confirm the dev environment simply wasn’t running them

#	What the screenshots show	Class	Possible causes	How to verify
5	Counts disagree: 33 published rides; 29 upcoming plus 17 completed plus 3 cancelled (49); “8 of 29” in search; 2 active bookings vs 4 pending requests; 14 saved alerts	Definition or data	Different definitions (all-time vs active, series vs rides)	Write one definition per metric; compare with a direct count query; label every number precisely or remove it
6	Ride alerts: identical rows (dashboard says 14)	Data or validation	No uniqueness check on create; repeated test runs	Group alerts by route, window and seats; add a server-side duplicate check
7	Find rides: all results are the signed-in user’s own rides	Rule	The search doesn’t exclude the requesting driver	Inspect the search endpoint’s filters; decide the product rule
8	One driver, rating 5.0 (12), identical review text from one reviewer	Seed data	Dev seeds	Check the ratings table for distinct raters; confirm one rating per booking is enforced
9	Display name “Arjun Verma (Student Driver)”; other names like “Student Commuter”	Data	Role placed in the name field by the seed	Check the stored display name; keep roles out of names
10	Vehicle plate “INVALID123”	Validation or data	No server-side format validation; seed	Test the create endpoint with a bad plate; add validation and clean the data

#	What the screenshots show	Class	Possible causes	How to verify
11	Capacities 4, 4 and 5 for similar cars	Semantics or data	Total seats vs passenger seats	Check what the column stores; check the Fortuner entry
12	“MANUAL_ID_REVIEW” shown raw	Visual (mapping)	Enum printed directly	Add a label map for every enum (booking, verification, vehicle)
13	“Local Dev Fast-Fill (Test Accounts)” on sign-in	**Security / configuration**	Dev control not gated	Search the production bundle for the string; confirm the backend routes it uses are disabled when the environment is production
14	“Saved Commute Routes (8)” but two pills	UI or data	Deduplicated or truncated in the UI; the count includes duplicates	Compare the API response with the rendered list
15	Paused schedule with 10 rides still generated	Product rule	Pause stops future generation only	Confirm the intended behaviour and write the status line accordingly
16	Offer a ride: “Required” in red on first view; time prefilled with the current time	Logic	Form state starts in an error state; initial time defaults to now	Inspect the form’s initial state
17	“Showing 8 of 29” with no visible pagination	Functional	Page size without a Load more control	Check the pagination parameters

#	What the screenshots show	Class	Possible causes	How to verify
18	Placeholder “vitstudent.ac.in”	Content assumption	Hard-coded example; not confirmed with VIT	Confirm real student and faculty domains with VIT
19	Demo records generally present	Hygiene	Seeds mixed into the normal experience	Keep seeds in a dev-only script; production databases must start empty

14. Prioritized implementation roadmap

Principles. Small pull requests (one page or component family each); no logic changes in the same pull request as layout changes; every pull request lists the routes it touches; screenshots before and after; the existing backend, authentication, student/faculty separation, booking safeguards and routes stay exactly as they are. **Instructions for the coding agent:** don’t modify backend code, authorization or audience filtering; don’t replace working behaviour with placeholders or mock data; build a shared component the first time a phase needs it; keep old components until the last page using them is migrated; run the existing tests with every change.

Phase	Scope	Priority	Risk controls	Exit criteria
0. Baseline and guardrails (about 1 day)	Playwright script that captures all 13 routes at 375, 768 and 1280 px with fixed fixture data; axe scan baseline; check issue 13 (dev fast-fill) in the production build; start the data investigations in Section 13 in parallel	P0	Nothing in the UI changes	Baseline images and axe report committed; fast-fill confirmed absent from production

Phase	Scope	Priority	Risk controls	Exit criteria
1. Design-system foundations	`tokens.css`; font; reset; Button, TextField, Select, Card, StatusBadge, RouteSpine, SeatDots, Skeleton, EmptyState, ErrorState, Alert, Dialog; old class names aliased to tokens	P0	New components used only in new code; existing pages untouched	Components documented with all states in 9.4; axe clean on a sample page
2. Shell and navigation	`PageShell` widths, `AppHeader`, `BottomNav`, `AccountMenu`, My trips and Inbox layouts; remove the app footer	P0	Routes unchanged (layout wrappers only)	No wrapping at 320–1440 px; five-item bottom bar; full keyboard navigation
3. Core journeys	Home copy and hero, Sign-in, Find rides (RideCard, filters, RequestSeatSheet), Offer a ride, Bookings, inline Accept / Decline	P0/P1	One journey per pull request; compare with baseline	Keyboard-only completion of search → request seat and offer a ride; GOV.UK error pattern in all forms
4. Management pages	Dashboard, Driving, Schedules, Alerts, Vehicles	P1	Depends on Section 13 findings for counts, alerts and stale bookings	Dashboard shows next trip first; no metric cards; grouped schedules
5. Secondary pages	Messages (two panes), Notifications, Profile, verification status screens; admin and moderation after their screenshots are reviewed	P1/P2	Messages only after the duplicate investigation (item 1)	Unread logic consistent; all enums mapped to labels

Phase	Scope	Priority	Risk controls	Exit criteria
6. Responsive, accessibility and regression pass	Fix 320 px and 200% zoom issues; screen reader pass (VoiceOver and NVDA); update baselines; remove dead styles	P1	Baseline diffs reviewed by a human	Section 15 checklist fully passes

P0 (essential): navigation, widths and shell; removal of internal wording; dev fast-fill gating; dashboard hierarchy; inline driver requests; status badge with next action; form validation pattern; data investigations.

P1 (high impact): ride card and filters; request-seat sheet; grouped driving and schedules; messages two-pane; notifications logic; vehicle verification display; profile and verification states; empty, loading and error states everywhere.

P2 (refinement): map column in Find rides; dark theme through tokens; duplicate-alert banner; “last matched” on alerts; richer ride details; optional light illustration set for empty states.

15. Measurable visual and usability quality checklist

Thresholds marked (target) are my proposals, not research-derived numbers.

Layout and navigation

- [ ] No navigation label wraps at any width from 320 to 1440 px.
- [ ] Bottom bar has exactly five items; desktop header is one row at 1024 px and above.
- [ ] Every page uses `PageShell`; exactly three content widths exist in the CSS.
- [ ] No horizontal scroll at 320 px; layouts hold at 200% browser zoom.

Visual consistency

- [ ] Only the token palette is used: a search of the CSS finds no stray hex colours or one-off font sizes.
- [ ] One card style (border, 12 px radius, no shadow); no nested bordered boxes; shadows appear only on overlays.
- [ ] Brand blue appears only in the places listed in 6.1.
- [ ] Route spine and status badge look identical on every page.

Forms and states

- [ ] No error text appears before interaction or submit; submit shows an error summary plus per-field messages; input is never cleared.
- [ ] Every list and data region has designed loading, empty and error states.
- [ ] Every destructive action has a confirmation that names the consequence.

Accessibility

- [ ] axe reports zero serious or critical issues on all 13 routes at three viewports.
- [ ] Lighthouse accessibility score of at least 95 on key pages (target).
- [ ] Search → request seat, offer a ride, accept a request, cancel a booking and sign-in are completed with the keyboard only.
- [ ] All text pairs meet 4.5:1 (3:1 large); controls and focus rings 3:1; every status has text and an icon.
- [ ] Touch targets are at least 44 px; no target is below 24 px.
- [ ] Reduced-motion setting removes all non-essential motion.

Content

- [ ] A search of the codebase finds none of: “Platform preview”, “Planned”, “Design Requirement”, “cohort”, “directional matching”, raw enum strings, “Fast-Fill”.
- [ ] Claims on the home page match behaviour that is live in production.

Data hygiene (before real users)

- [ ] Production data contains no seed or demo rows.
- [ ] Each Section 13 item is closed, accepted or documented.
- [ ] Unread counts, dashboard counts and list lengths reconcile with direct database counts.

Usability test (target): five participants (at least two faculty and two students). Tasks: find and ask for a seat; offer a recurring commute; accept a request; find your next trip; cancel a booking. Pass if at least four of five complete each task unaided and no one mistakes a pending request for a confirmed one. Re-run after Phase 4 and Phase 6.

Open questions that would sharpen this blueprint

1. Which CSS approach and component libraries does the app use today (Tailwind, CSS modules, a UI kit)? This decides how tokens are wired in.

2. Which API fields exist: series id and service date on rides, pagination, distance, unread counts, vehicle verification state?
3. What are VIT’s real student and faculty email domains and verification routes? Copy and placeholders depend on it.
4. Can you share mobile-width screenshots and the admin and moderation screens so I can specify them?
5. What should “Edit schedule” do to existing rides and bookings? The form warning must match the behaviour.